FRANCEGO VIP TRANSFERS & TOURS

Client Guide: Google Maps API Setup

Complete step-by-step instructions for business owners to set up Google Maps Platform, enable required Routes & Places APIs, and configure credentials for FranceGo.

CLIENT SETUP MANUAL | GOOGLE MAPS PLATFORM | STEP-BY-STEP

Target Website: https://francegotransfers.io

Required APIs: Routes API, Places API (New), Geocoding API

Free Monthly Tier: Google provides $200 free monthly credit (covers thousands of transfers)

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Overview: Why FranceGo Needs a Google Maps Key

The FranceGo VIP transfer platform utilizes Google Maps Platform for three essential features:

1. **Live France Address & Landmark Autocomplete:** When passengers type hotels, airports, train stations, or tourist attractions (such as *ZooParc de Beauval*, *Eiffel Tower*, or *Disneyland Paris*), Google automatically autocompletes exact street addresses across France.
2. **Point-to-Point Distance & Mileage Fare Calculation:** Calculates exact driving distance (km) and travel duration to dynamically compute fixed rates (2.00 €/km for Sedan and 2.70 €/km for Minivan).
3. **Google Business Profile Reviews Sync:** Automatically pulls customer star ratings, review counts, and verified testimonials directly from your Google Business Profile onto the website.

> **GOOGLE $200 FREE MONTHLY CREDIT**
>
> Google provides every Google Cloud account with **$200 in free usage credits every single month**. For a private chauffeur business, this easily covers tens of thousands of address searches and distance calculations at zero net cost.

Step-by-Step Setup Instructions

1 Create or Log In to Google Cloud Console

1. Open your web browser and navigate to: https://console.cloud.google.com/
2. Log in using your official business Google / Gmail account.
3. At the top left, click the **Project Dropdown**, then click **"NEW PROJECT"**.
4. Enter project name: `FranceGo Transfers` and click **Create**.

2 Set Up Billing Account (Required by Google)

1. Navigate to **Billing** in the left menu (or search "Billing" in the top search bar).
2. Link a credit/debit card to activate your Google Cloud account.
3. *Note:* Google will not charge you unless your monthly usage exceeds the $200 free monthly allowance.

3 Enable the Required Google Maps APIs

Go to **Google Maps Platform > APIs & Services** (console.cloud.google.com/google/maps-apis/api-list).

Locate and click **ENABLE** on the following 2 essential APIs:

API Name	Role in FranceGo	Importance
Routes API	Computes driving kilometers, travel duration & dynamic vehicle fares (2.00€/km Car, 2.70€/km Van). Replaces legacy Directions and Distance Matrix APIs.	**CRITICAL**
Places API (New)	Autocompletes French addresses, hotels, theme parks (ZooParc de Beauval, Disney), and pulls Google Reviews.	**CRITICAL**
Geocoding API	Translates street addresses to geographical coordinates.	Recommended

4 Generate the API Key

1. On the left sidebar menu, click on **Keys & Credentials** (or visit console.cloud.google.com/google/maps-apis/credentials).
2. Click **"+ CREATE CREDENTIALS"** at the top, then choose **"API key"**.
3. Your new API key will be generated (starting with `AIzaSy...`). Copy this key.

5 Configure Key Restrictions (CRITICAL STEP)

Click on the newly generated API key (or click the **pencil / edit icon** next to it) to open its settings:

A. Set Application Restriction: Select "NONE"

> **CRITICAL SETTING: SET TO "NONE"**
>
> Under **"Set an application restriction"**, select **"None"**.
>
> **Why?** The FranceGo backend runs on a dedicated secure server (Node.js/Next.js) that talks directly to Google over private server-to-server channels. Restricting by "IP address" will cause Google to block requests because the server connects via IPv6. Restricting by "Websites / HTTP Referrer" will cause Google to block server-side requests. Since this key is kept strictly in the private server `.env` file and is never exposed in browser code, setting application restriction to **"None"** is completely secure.

B. Set API Restrictions: Select "Don't restrict key"

Under **"API restrictions"**:

- Select **"Don't restrict key"** (Recommended - ensures all route and address services work smoothly).
- *OR*, if you prefer restricting, select **"Restrict key"** and check:
  - [x] **Routes API**
  - [x] **Places API (New)**
  - [x] **Geocoding API**

Click the blue **SAVE** button at the bottom.

Step-by-Step: Finding Your Google Place ID

To display your business reviews and star ratings on FranceGo, we also need your **Google Place ID**:

1. Open the official Google Place ID Finder:
   https://developers.google.com/maps/documentation/places/web-service/place-id
2. In the map search bar, type your exact Google Business name:
   Example: `FranceGo VIP Transfer, Rue Scandicci, Pantin`
3. Click on your business pin on the map.
4. Copy the displayed **Place ID** (e.g. `ChIJK_W2Fipt5kcRCOpTeqfLY6g`).

What to Deliver to the Development Team

Once you finish the steps above, please copy and email / WhatsApp the following 3 items to the tech team:

Parameter	Example Format	Where Found
1. Google Maps API Key	`AIzaSyDNgoZLJXN1yNrPkUWzdZ3DCjKGbPZPZ...`	Google Cloud Console > Keys & Credentials
2. Google Place ID	`ChIJK_W2Fipt5kcRCOpTeqfLY6g`	Google Place ID Finder tool
3. Google Reviews Share Link	`https://maps.app.goo.gl/DwYGzJ9yDqszXAPW7`	Google Maps > Your Business > Share profile

> **QUESTIONS OR TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE?**
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> If you encounter any difficulty during setup, contact the FranceGo Technical Operations Desk:
> **Hotline & WhatsApp:** +33 7 81 11 83 94
> **Email:** projet15df@outlook.fr
> **Target Production Website:** https://francegotransfers.io